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Samsung Galaxy M53 5G

Premium build and display, but is it enough?

The Samsung Galaxy M53 5G is Samsung's latest entrant in the company's M series of smartphones and the direct successor to the wildly popular Samsung Galaxy M32. Boasting an array of alluring features, the Samsung Galaxy M53 looks like a promising device, on paper, at least. However, does it justify its asking price of ₹26,499? Let's find out.

BUILD AND DESIGN

Sticking to classic design thematic, the Samsung Galaxy M53 5G is one of the most suave-looking phones under ₹30,000, in our opinion. The device is equipped with a polycarbonate rear panel with a smooth matte finish that feels fantastic in the hand. The phone is also super lightweight and thin. At the top left corner of the rear panel, you have a quad-camera set up on an island that melds quite seamlessly into the frame, giving the device a premium look. On the right side, you have a power button that doubles as a pretty snappy fingerprint sensor. The phone lacks stereo speakers and a 3.5 mm audio jack, which may irk some.

DISPLAY

The Samsung Galaxy M53 phone sports a 6.7-inch Super AMOLED Plus display with Full HD+ resolution and 120 Hz refresh rate support. It comes with excellent viewing angles, crisp content, and accurate colour reproduction. The display's contrast makes for an immersive viewing experience with deep blacks and vivid colours. In our tests, the phone touched about 390-400 nits with Adaptive Brightness turned on. Screen legibility does take a slight hit in harsh sunlight at times but otherwise, it is a perfectly usable display in most lighting conditions.

The display is capable of 120 Hz smooth refresh rate. Scrolling is a smooth affair and it makes the phone's performance feel snappy and seamless.



Price
₹26,499

PERFORMANCE

The Samsung Galaxy M53 5G comes packing a MediaTek Dimensity 900 SoC under the hood that offers balanced performance for daily use. The phone performed decently well in synthetic benchmarking apps. It clocked in similar scores when compared to other phones with the same SoC. However, when we ran the CPU Throttling Test, the Samsung Galaxy M53 throttled to a whopping 56 per cent of its maximum performance in merely 15 minutes. This indicates that the phone isn't too capable of sustained performance under intensive workloads.

We also played a few games such as Call Of Duty: Mobile and Asphalt 9 Legends on the phone. In COD: Mobile, the phone gave us 59 fps at 89 per cent stability (Medium Graphics) while in Asphalt, we got 30 fps at 99 per cent stability. While these scores are decent, we did encounter some lags and frame drops while gaming and the phone also got pretty toasty after about 15 minutes.

CAMERA

The Samsung Galaxy M53 features a quad-camera array headlined by a 108 MP shooter. Daylight images look

pretty vibrant and detailed. However, when images are taken in tricky lighting conditions, the camera tends to crush the shadows or overexpose highlights slightly. The Samsung M53 also had some issues focusing on the main camera. Portrait images were decent on the Samsung with great natural skin tones and decent detail. Macro shots from the 2 MP lens are decent and ultrawide pictures are pretty good for the price. The 32 MP selfie camera is definitely the strongest link in the Samsung Galaxy M53's camera setup. You get detailed pictures with excellent colours and natural skin tones.

BATTERY LIFE

The Samsung Galaxy M53 5G boasts a 5,000 mAh battery with 25 W fast charging. The phone's battery easily got us through a day's worth of usage consisting of tasks such as gaming, photo editing, and social media browsing. The phone lasted approximately 16 hours in our video loop test.



BUILD	68
FEATURES	70
PERFORMANCE	60
VALUE	65

VERDICT

The Samsung Galaxy M53 5G is an easy recommendation for those who value build quality, design and screen performance the most. Additionally, the large 6.7-inch Super AMOLED Plus display is a treat to watch content on, however, the device does miss out on stereo speakers. However, the camera and gaming performance isn't as reliable as some competitors on the market from Xiaomi and Realme.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

PROCESSOR: MediaTek Dimensity 900 5G | CPU: Octa-core (2x2.4 GHz Cortex-A78 & 6x2.0 GHz Cortex-A55) | GPU: Mali-G68 MC4 | RAM: 6 / 8 GB | ROM: 128 GB | EXPANDABLE STORAGE: Up to 1 TB | DISPLAY: 6.7-inch Super AMOLED Plus FHD+ | REFRESH RATE: 120 Hz | REAR CAMERAS: 108 MP + 8 MP + 2 MP + 2 MP | FRONT CAMERA: 32 MP | WEIGHT: 176 g | BATTERY: 5,000 mAh | FAST CHARGING: 25 W

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